Let’s look at a layout template:

```
<html>
  <head>
    <title>Form: <%= controller.action_name %></title>
    <%= stylesheet_link_tag 'scaffold' %>
  </head>

  <body>

    <%= yield :layout %>

  </body>
</html>
```

The layout sets out a standard HTML page, with the head and body sections. It uses the current action name as the page title and includes a CSS file. In the body is a call to `yield`. This is where the magic takes place. When the template for the action was rendered, Rails stored its content, labeling it `:layout`. Inside the layout template, calling `yield` retrieves this text. In fact, `:layout` is the default content returned when rendering, so you can write `yield` instead of `yield :layout`. We personally prefer the slightly more explicit version.

Suppose the `my_action.html.erb` template contained this:

```
<h1><%= @msg %></h1>
```

And also suppose the controller set `@msg` to `Hello, World!`. Then the browser would see the following HTML:

```
<html>
  <head>
    <title>Form: my_action</title>
    <link href="/stylesheets/scaffold.css" media="screen"
          rel="Stylesheet" type="text/css" />
  </head>
  <body>
```